

Nathan Turczan

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SUMMARY

Product designer who ships the products he designs. Eight years designing creative software across iOS, iPadOS, macOS, and web, shipping it end to end: documentation, development, and testing. I take intricate, workflow-driven problems (real-time harmony, networked performance, pitch correction) and turn them into elegant, direct-manipulation experiences. AI is part of my daily design process: describe, prototype, refine, backed by a knowledge base that compounds. MFA from CalArts; published at NIME. Deep in creative-app craft, from layout and typography to motion and behavior.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Designer - Scale Navigator, LLC 2021 - Present

- Designed, built, and shipped a suite of music-creation tools across web, iOS, Android, macOS/Windows desktop, and DAW plugins (VST3/AU/AAX—Logic Pro compatible) as the sole designer and developer.

Products Shipped:

- Scale Navigator Dashboard** — direct-manipulation instrument for navigating harmonic space (based on Tymoczko's *Geometry of Music*); one source of truth for scale/chord state, broadcast via MIDI and parameter automation (Web, iOS, Android, VST3, AU)
- Ensemble Jammer** — networked multiplayer instruments where the interface guarantees no wrong notes; onboarding a non-musician to playing in an ensemble in under 60 seconds (Web, iOS)
- Tonalign** — real-time MIDI pitch correction; wrong notes become right notes (VST3, AU)
- SNaPS** — scale-aware sampler with three engines; AI sample-ingestion pipeline (Spotify's Basic Pitch) auto-tags pitch-class metadata
- NotesChordScales** — real-time chord and scale inference (Web, AU)

Product Manager - FutureCare 2022 - 2025

- Led product for **Wave of Wellness** (iOS/Android), a React Native wellness dashboard integrating 5+ sensor types (motion, bed, door, medication, air quality); 9 agency partnerships, ~60 active installs
- Shipped a custom **Crestron Home Driver** (published on Crestron Drivers Portal); coordinated cross-functional teams, ran Agile and pilots

Sound Designer - Output Inc. 2021

- Sound design and kit creation for **Arcade**, Output's flagship subscription instrument

Composer & Sound Designer - Freelance 2018 - Present

- SOULS** (2022) with Sia & David O'Reilly — generative music system for 10,000 interactive NFT characters; Billboard #3 music NFT (July 2022), Designboom, Forbes
- Refik Anadol Studio's WDC** *Dreams* (LA Phil centennial) — sound-file tagging and data prep
- CTO, **Chordas Collective** (vocal-electronic ensemble); Founder, **LA Laptop Orchestra** (participatory music project); scores for iHeartRadio

Associate Product Manager - SPG Studios 2020 - 2021

- APM for **Remoto**, cloud ADR software for film/TV post-production; owned milestones and technical specs

Adjunct Instructor - California Institute of the Arts 2021 - 2022

- Taught Media + Web Development (Music Technology): weekly lectures, live demos, and group critique sessions

SKILLS

Design: Product & interaction design, visual craft (layout, typography, motion), prototyping in code, design systems

Build: React, TypeScript, Web Audio API, Tone.js, D3.js, Firebase, JUCE/C++, MIDI

Domain: Creative-app & instrument design, music theory, DAW plugins (VST3/AU/AAX)

EDUCATION

MFA, Music Technology - California Institute of the Arts 2019

Workshop in Algorithmic Computer Music - UC Santa Cruz (studied directly under David Cope) 2012

SPEAKING & PUBLICATION

Invited Lectures: [Stanford CCRMA](#) (2026), [California Institute of the Arts](#) (2026), Middlebury College (2026)

Paper & Presentation: Turczan, N. (2019). *The Scale Navigator: A System for Networked Algorithmic Harmony*. NIME 2019, Porto Alegre.